

VARSHA SATHYANARAYANAN

Category Manager

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CONTACT

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EDUCATION

Humber College, Longo School of Business
Sept 2023 - Aug 2024
National Institute of Fashion Technology (NIFT), Bachelor of Design, Fashion Design
July 2016 - July 2020

SKILLS

Core CompetenciesAssortment Planning · OTB Management · Category Management · Fashion Buying · Vendor Management · Inventory Control · Forecasting · TNA Calendar Tracking · Product Lifecycle Management (PLM) · Order TrackingToolsAdvanced MS Excel (VLOOKUP, Pivot Tables, Dashboards) · MS Word · Google Sheets · Canva · Meta Ads Manager · SAP (PO/Inventory Tracking - Basic)Functional StrengthsCross-Functional Collaboration · Trend Analysis · Sales Performance Reporting · Catalog & Content Management · E-commerce Marketing · Vendor Negotiation

PROFILE

NIFT-trained merchandiser with relevant experience in fashion buying, category management, and P&L ownership across retail and e-commerce. Built a women's casualwear category from zero, delivering ₹3.5L revenue in 2 months and improving margins from 22% to 35% through vendor negotiation and assortment optimization. Proven ability to manage 200+ SKUs, improve sell-through by 15%, and expand assortments from 5 to 25+ subcategories by onboarding 12+ vendors. Experienced in PO/PI coordination, PLM workflows, and WIP tracking for bottom-wear, casualwear, and accessories across multi-channel environments. Advanced Excel user (pivot tables, VLOOKUP, dashboards) with a data-driven approach to markdowns, replenishment, and sell-through analysis. While OTB management has been implicit within broader category ownership, rapid learning and commercial instinct enable quick formalization of OTB processes for fast-paced fashion cycles.

EXPERIENCE

Category Manager - Fashion

SuperK, Bangalore, India
Nov 2025 - Present

Built the fashion category from near zero across online channels and a tech-enabled retail network of 3+ co-co stores, launching assortments across apparel, footwear, and accessories while driving vendor expansion, category P&L management, and data-led merchandising decisions.

- Built a women's casualwear category from near zero to 25+ subcategories by onboarding 12+ regional vendors, identifying assortment gaps, and benchmarking against value retailers, delivering ₹3.5 lakh in revenue within two months.
- Negotiated vendor pricing and MOQs to improve product margins from 22% to 35% while maintaining competitive retail pricing, demonstrating commercial acumen in margin optimization.
- Analyzed weekly sales performance and customer demand signals to drive assortment rationalization, improving category gross margin by ~6% and reducing stock-outs by ~20% across priority SKUs.
- Partnered with marketing to launch fashion-led campaigns during key festivals, increasing category visibility by ~22% and driving ~15% uplift in campaign sales.
- Managed 200+ SKUs at Go Colors, improving sell-through by 15% through data-led replenishment and assortment adjustments, and launched 3+ new sub-categories including kids-wear, boosting category sales by 15% in the first quarter.
- Built Excel-based WIP trackers and coordinated with 20+ suppliers across India and Asia, ensuring 95% on-time delivery for seasonal production orders and reducing post-launch return rates to under 10%.

Founder

The Style Gram, Remote - Chennai, India
Nov 2024 - Jun 2025

Built and operated a lean fashion reselling brand focused on affordable women's western-wear, managing end-to-end sourcing, merchandising, content creation, and customer engagement across Instagram and Swiggy Minis.

- Operated a lean fashion brand generating ₹50,000 revenue in launch phase with zero returns, sourcing 60+ SKUs at 45% gross margins and reducing catalog errors by 90% through custom tracking systems.